

51Talk IELTS Speaking-Advanced
雅思口语高级
——冲刺 7.5 分



Unit 7 Culture

Topic 4—Lesson 1(上篇)

A cultural event in your culture/country



I. Pronunciation Practice (2 minutes)

When to Pause

Pauses occur:

1. before punctuation marks;
2. before conjunctions;
3. between grammatical units such as phrases, clauses, and sentences.

Read the following passage and mark out where to pause.



There is nothing wrong in wanting to get rich./ The desire for riches/
is really the desire for a richer,/ fuller,/ and more abundant life;/
and that desire is praiseworthy. —Wallace D. Wattles

II. IELTS Speaking Part 1 (8 minutes)



Extend your answer to 3-4 sentences. It's easier to get 7.5.

1. Imagine you are a candidate in the IELTS test. The teacher is an examiner. Please answer the questions below with what you have learned to develop your IELTS answers. (4 minutes)

What do Chinese people like to collect?

What did you collect when you were young?

What can people get from their collections?



The examiner will score your answer from the following aspects:

1. How good you are at **keeping talking** at the right speed and **connecting your ideas together**;
2. **How much vocabulary** you have and **how well** you use it;
3. **How many structures** you have and **how well** you use them;
4. How well you **pronounce** the language.

2. Read and learn the following key words and models for the IELTS Part 1. You are suggested to apply these words in the following steps. (4 minutes)

Key Words and Models

watercolour painting



Example: Many Chinese people with adequate pocket money collect various things depending on the individuals' own preferences. Generally, some people in China will collect **watercolour paintings**, which depict landscapes or ancient Chinese characters. Meanwhile, some Chinese people collect postcards or stamps that have some kind of historical significance.

morbid



Example: When I was young, I collected all manner of things, especially those related to geology and biology. I used to collect rock samples from the surrounding countryside. I remember hauling loads of rocks from all over the landscape. Although this may seem **morbid** to some, I also collected bones. I once wanted to be an archeologist, so naturally I went on dig missions and excavated various skeletal remains!

intrinsic



Example: I think collecting things is **intrinsic** to many different types of animals, especially for humans. However, people tend to collect things based on either necessity or desire. Naturally, people collect food and items needed for shelter, but they also collect things that hold a monetary value, which can offer a sense of security. On the other hand, people collect things because it brings them pleasure.

III. IELTS Speaking Part 2 (12 minutes)

1. Brainstorm. Plan your answers based on the given questions. (1 minute)

**Describe an important traditional event
(in your culture/country).**

- When is this event held?
- Who attends this event?
- What do people do during this event?
- Why is this event important?



Tips: During the first stage of Part 2, you don't need to talk. Keep the questions in mind and think them over.



2.1 Here is a model for the IELTS Speaking Part 2. We will focus on the words and expressions highlighted and in red below. (8 minutes)

Model 1

What this event is and when it is held: The event I would like to discuss is named the **Tomb Sweeping Festival**. The festival takes place during the blossoming of flowers in spring, probably because spring signifies new life. Furthermore, spring is the most pleasant season in China, and thus it is a remarkably convenient time to carry out this festival of **mourning and remembrance**.

What people do during this event and who attends: Much is done during the brief public holidays. Family members crowd at cemeteries to, as the name suggests, sweep the tombs of their ancestors and ensure everything is in order. Once the tombs have been thoroughly cleaned, the family members usually lay flowers and other offerings such as alcohol and food in the hope that those departed will still be able to enjoy such lavish treats. It's not unusual to see people burning paper money on the sides of streets too, which are meant to be **passed on to** the dead so they can live out their lives in luxury.

Why this event is important: Varied feelings are felt during this time for me. Personally, I don't know many of those my parents mourn and therefore I don't share the burden of their grief. However, I think it is important to remember your roots and where you come from, and this cultural event serves to remind us of this fact.



You are required to talk for the full 2 minutes.

2.2 Imagine you are a candidate in the IELTS test. The teacher is an examiner. Please answer the questions below with what you have learned to develop your IELTS answers. (3 minutes)

**Describe an important traditional event
(in your culture/country).**

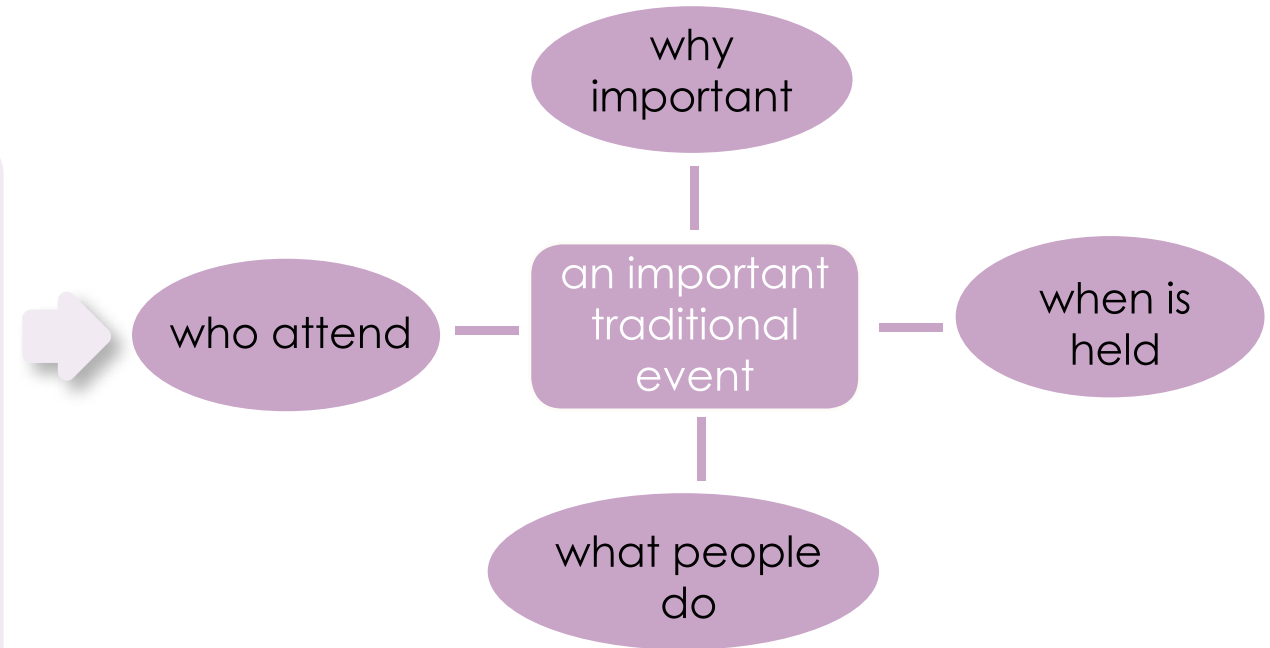
You should say:

when this event is held

who attend this event

what people do during this event

and **explain why** this event is important.



Homework: Please use the model for these two topics for further practice.

Describe a unique cultural event you know.

Describe an economic event of your hometown.

Review (2 minutes)



Key Words & Expressions

watercolour painting

morbid

intrinsic

Tomb Sweeping Festival

mourning and remembrance

pass on to



Key Sentences

Generally, Chinese people will collect **watercolour paintings**, which depict landscapes or ancient Chinese characters.

Although this may seem **morbid** to some, I also collected bones.

I think collecting things is **intrinsic** to many different types of animals, especially for humans.

The event I would like to discuss is named the **Tomb Sweeping Festival**.

And thus it is a remarkably convenient time to carry out this festival of **mourning and remembrance**.

It's not unusual to see people burning paper money on the sides of streets too, which are meant to **be passed on to** the dead so they can live out their lives in luxury.

You will learn more about this topic in Lesson 2.